

Saladin's revenge

In 1097, before Saladin was born, the Crusaders had captured Jerusalem, killing many of its inhabitants, and taken control of the Holy Land. Saladin was determined to retake it for Muslims, and he declared a **holy war** against the Crusaders. In 1187, with a huge army, Saladin **CRUSHED HIS ENEMIES** at the Battle of Hattin, and the Crusader King of Jerusalem, Guy of Lusignan, was forced to surrender (pictured right).

Saladin retook Jerusalem, but, unlike the Crusaders, he allowed its inhabitants to leave the city peacefully.



By the way...

when I heard that Richard the Lionheart had a fever, I sent him peaches, pears, and ice from the top of Mount Hermon, 100 miles (160 km) away.

The Crusaders strike back

In 1189, England's king, **Richard the Lionheart**, led the Third Crusade. They retook the city of Acre, but the siege took two years, and the other kings returned home. Richard couldn't beat Saladin alone, so they **MADE PEACE**. Christians were allowed to visit Jerusalem again, but **their rule of the Holy Land had ended for good**.



Chivalrous knight

In the Muslim world, Saladin is remembered as the man who united the Arab people and liberated Jerusalem. Even in Europe, Saladin was revered as a chivalrous knight—in fact, an epic poem was written about his exploits.

Did you know?

After a lifetime of campaigning, Saladin left an empire stretching north from Egypt, but he died almost penniless.



In 1183, Saladin captured the strategically important **CITADEL OF ALEPPO**. It was a crucial step on his way to retaking Jerusalem



IBN SHADDAD (1145–1234) wrote a biography about Saladin called **THE RARE AND EXCELLENT HISTORY OF SALADIN**.